

MEDICAL DEVICES FOR HOME-USE

Deeksha Sharma

In the fast-paced modern life, it is difficult to find time to visit doctors for regular checkups. However, we must all be aware of our various health parameters like blood pressure, insulin levels, haemoglobin, pulse rate and so on. With the advent of portable medical testing devices, we can take care of ourselves from home, without having to visit medical facilities often. These devices are compact and easy to use. Home-based tests are cost-effective and provide real-time results. These devices have become essential to manage chronic conditions and can help us take active steps to improve our well-being.

Essential features

While purchasing a portable medical device, you must check its accuracy. A certification of accuracy will provide a sense of reliability.

A few basic features that you should check are compact size, lightweight and easy-to-use technology with preferably one-touch results. Higher storage capacity and support for multiple users will also be advantageous. However, additional features may be associated with higher cost.

Bluetooth connectivity is another feature available in most devices today. It allows

transferring of data wirelessly to a smart device to track progress. Some devices come with light indication, which can be intuitive to understand whether the readings are normal or not. Some devices deliver even audible results.

There are numerous health conditions that can be diagnosed with portable devices at home. We have picked three of the most common categories of health condition monitoring devices: blood pressure monitors, ECG monitors and blood sugar monitors.

Here is a list of products that we have picked up based on ease-of-use, availability and affordability. These products can be purchased from online vendors, respective product websites and from offline retail stores. You can explore devices from other vendors as well.

Blood pressure monitors

Hypertension, or hypotension, is one of the most common and ignored problems. High blood pressure increases the risk of severe health problems, including heart attack or stroke, if not controlled in due time. Whereas, low blood pressure can reduce the blood supply to the brain, causing dizziness and even fatal results like cardiac arrest. It is worth an investment to have a BP monitor at home.

Omron BP monitor. This product seems to be one of the most popular portable BP devices available in the market, with an accuracy of $\pm 3\text{mmHg}$. It is easy to use and has necessary features like body movement detection, irregular heartbeat detection, storage to track progress, Bluetooth connectivity and



light indicator. In case of no batteries available, Omron BP monitor HEM 8712 can work with an AC adaptor. This product is available online at a starting range of ₹ 1500, and comes with a five-year warranty.

Dr Trust BP monitor. This device is available at an even lower price range and has interesting features like voice assistance and colour change based on readings, making the prod-



uct interactive. It also includes all aforementioned necessary features and can store up to the latest 120 readings. It comes with four AA batteries and an AC adaptor. This product is available online starting at ₹ 1200. It comes with a five-year warranty.

ECG monitors

An ECG machine is generally needed by patients of cardiovascular diseases